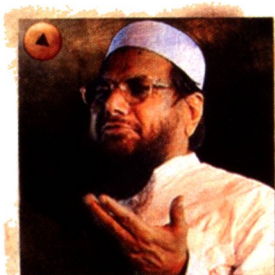


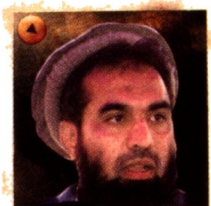
The Brains Trust



**HAFIZ MOHAMMAD
SAEED (58)**

Amir or overall leader of LeT, he plays a key role in the group's operational and fundraising activities worldwide

Masked as an Islamic charity, Jamaat-ud-Dawa, the Muridke-based Lashkar-e-Toiba has a clearly defined command and control structure for conducting terror operations against India



**ZAKIUR RAHMAN
LAKHVI (48)**

Overall operations chief of LeT, planned and executed Mumbai attacks. Sent operatives and funds to attack US forces in Iraq in 2004. Has reportedly received Al Qaeda-affiliated donations on behalf of the Lashkar. Now under arrest.



**H.M.
ASHRAF**
Chief of finance, uses his Middle East connections to raise funds



**M.M. A.
BAHAZIQ**
LeT's Saudi financier, has played a key role in group's propaganda



**AZAM
CHEEMA**
He is the launching commander for infiltrating militants into India



**ABU AL
KAMA**
Handles all Kashmir operations. Lives in an ISI safehouse in Faizabad.



**ABU
MUZAMMIL**
Another 26/11 plotter, he controls operations in the Indian hinterland

Kasab's Confessions

He was one of 32 trainees selected by Lakhvi who divided the 10-member team into five groups of two men each

Kasab and the team leader Ismail were codenamed the VTS team. They were shown targets on Google Earth and given information about how and where to get down in Mumbai.

His team was instructed to fire at rush hour between 7 and 11 a.m., and 7 and 11 p.m.

The operation was fixed for September 27 but later postponed. The 10 members stayed in Karachi and practised sailing using inflatable speed boats

Each member was given a rucksack containing eight grenades, one AK-47 rifle, 200 cartridges, two magazines and one cellphone.

crucial for governments worldwide to do all they can to stifle its fundraising and operations," he adds. Just six months later, Lashkar terrorists had massacred 163 civilians, including six Americans, in Mumbai.

The LeT was founded in 1986 as the Markaz-ul-Dawa wal Irshad by Prof Hafiz Mohammed Saeed of the University of Engineering and Technology, Lahore to train fighters for the war against the Soviets in Afghanistan. In a few years, they had switched focus to Jammu and Kashmir, quickly supplanting most other militant groups like the Harkat-ul-Mujahideen and becoming an in-house terror group of the ISI. "So enmeshed is the LeT with the Pakistan army establishment that its activists are known as 'sarkari mujahid' within Pakistan," says a top intelligence official.

Unlike the Jaish-e-Mohammad, floated by Maulana Masood Azhar, one of three terrorists released in exchange for the IC-814 hostages, LeT has few linkages with Al Qaeda, a crucial factor which made the US look the other way

all these years despite Lashkar being on its watch since 9/11. "Despite LeT's glaring linkages with the ISI, the US never pressed Pakistan to dismantle the outfit because it was never seen to be hurting the American interests until the Mumbai attack," says former army chief General V.P. Malik. Post Kargil, the LeT boosted flagging militancy in J&K with a series of suicide attacks, pushing in fighters from countries as diverse as Sudan and Jordan.

Through audacious terror strikes on Red Fort in January 2001, the IISc campus, the Ram Janmabhoomi complex in 2005 and the Mumbai attacks, the Lashkar is the not-so-hidden hand moving the spectre of terror into India's soft unprotected underbelly.

The relief activities are a garb and a very effective one that has endeared it to the people. In the aftermath of the 2005 earthquake which devastated Pok, Lashkar volunteers were among the first on the scene pulling out sur-

Graphics by PRASHANT CHAUDHARY